

EXPLORE.....

FREE



10

**Friends of Telford
Town Park**

**10th anniversary
2013**

**The newsletter of
The Friends of Telford Town Park
Edition 1 2013**

From the Chair.....

January 2013

Welcome to this first Explore newsletter of the New Year. 2012 was a very successful year for the Friends and we go into 2013 with our membership at an all time high and looking forward to our 10th birthday celebration in August. (See opposite page)

2013 also promises to be an exciting year for the Town Park itself; at the northern end

the extensive landscaping around the new Visitor Centre will be completed within the next few weeks and by early summer we should have a number of great new play features in place, including a water play area, crazy golf and a new rope course. The second phase of the Lottery funded Parks for People project will bring some significant improvements to other areas of the park, including new nature and heritage trails with interpretation boards and new access gates at the various entrances to the park.

Over the last 10 years the Friends, working closely with Telford & Wrekin Council staff, have played an important part in making the Park the unique asset that it is today and we plan to continue to do very much the same in 2013 and beyond. There is still an important role for a volunteer organisation like the Friends and we offer a very warm welcome to anyone who loves the Town Park and wishes to join us, to help in that task.

Colin Thompson, Chairman.



Colin Thompson

*We are extremely grateful to **Great Dawley Parish Council**
for sponsoring this newsletter*

Park Visitor Centre Reception Tel: 01952 -382340

www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

*Cover picture: Publicity shot (courtesy of the **Shropshire Star**) for Telford's 6th charity Santa Fun Run including Daniel the guide dog!*



10th Anniversary Celebration

JOLLY GREEN DAY

Lots of FREE fun for all the family
Crafts Cycling Walking
Recycling Wood Turning
Arena Displays Local produce

Don't miss it! Saturday

17th August 2013
11am - 4pm

Queen Elizabeth II Field
Telford Town Park
in association with

Telford's

6th Santa Fun Run



Left are pictured (courtesy of the **Shropshire Star**) just a few of the one hundred 'santas' who ran round the Town Park on Sunday 9th December raising around £1,000 for charity. The beneficiaries are the **Royal National Institute for the Blind and Guide Dogs UK**.

The day was overcast but mostly dry and more importantly not icy!

Chris Harrison from Randlay kindly gave his time to do a brilliant job of compering with equipment supplied by RMP Events Ltd.

Afterwards, warm mulled fruit punch was enjoyed by all participants along with mince pies kindly donated by the **Co-Op Supermarket, Stirchley**. Everyone agreed it was a fabulous morning and said they would return next year and encourage more to do the same. This year (2013) will be the 7th Santa Fun Run organised by the Friends of Telford town Park to raise money for 2 very deserving charities, helping those people who cannot enjoy our park in the same way that we do. A big thank you to all who supported this event and we'll see you all again on Sunday the **8th December** this year!

Bird & Bat Boxes

Thanks to Madeley and Stirchley & Brookside Parish Councils more bird and bat boxes are being erected by the Friends in the Town Park. This is an ongoing project to encourage and promote wildlife in Telford Town Park, particularly as there has been a lot of disruption due to the works to improve the park. The bat walks in 2012 indicated that there was no obvious loss of bats in the park so it must be working! There is a bird box making session on Wednesday 20th February at 10am and at 1pm a bat box making session. These take place at the Visitor Centre and ALL are welcome but please register your interest with Catherine Anderson on [REDACTED].



'Drop in' Gardening Days

Our 'drop in' gardening days are now up and running and thanks to some wonderful training from Teresa Rham of Groundesigns, Oswestry, we are now achieving lots of improvements to the Chelsea Gardens. The next major project is the designing of a small sensory garden as part of the Chelsea Gardens. We are starting from scratch on a fairly level site and hope to have the new area open by late Spring. If you would like to help with this or any other project on a casual basis we meet up at 10am at the Visitor Centre every 1st and 3rd Wednesday of every month. You will be most welcome to assist us with some light gardening!

Photo Competition

First prize in our 2012 photo competition was won by Lois Salisbury with a stunning picture of one of the ponds in the Chelsea Gardens. Her prize was a photo training day at a Mark Sissons birds of prey workshop. The entries are all on display in the Visitor Centre and a 2013 calendar has been produced showcasing another 12 pictures from the entries. Calendars are priced at £3 & £5 for A5 and A4 sizes respectively, available from reception staff at the Visitor Centre.





Photos courtesy of Paul Belford



Heritage

*More
exciting
finds
at the
Stirchley
Chimney
site*

*Left
the tunnel
discovery*

Work has continued, thanks to some ongoing funding, at the Stirchley Chimney site in the park. An unexpected find was the uncovering of a tunnel which heads east from the chimney under the footpath. Many other foundations of various buildings have also been unearthed and it is hoped to achieve further Lottery funding in this respect. It should be helped by the earlier discovery of what is believed to be the first blast furnace designed and patented by Thomas Botfield. To find out more about this wonderful historic site in the Town Park, Google 'Paul Belford Archaeology' to access the blog. You can also fill in a form at the Visitor Centre to keep up to date with any other activities in the park. The chimney site is normally open daily with FREE admission from 9.30am until 4.30pm. Pick up a leaflet from the Visitor Centre.

SAFETY IN THE PARK

Our beautiful park is generally a very safe and pleasant place to enjoy, however, there are sometimes a tiny number of people who seek to spoil your enjoyment of our 450 acres. If you see any criminal activity such as graffiti spraying, motor cycle or quad bikes riding, wanton damage to trees or structures, please call the **non emergency Police number 101** (then press **2** for West Mercia Police) and inform them of the activity. It would also help during working hours to call the Park Reception on **01952 - 382340**.

We have a very good and close relationship with the local police which has helped to keep our park a peaceful and pleasant place to be in. For **LIFE** threatening emergencies always dial **999** or **112** from a mobile.



If you would like to help us celebrate our 10 years of service to the Town Park, come and join us. Working membership is FREE!

There will be lots of opportunity for learning about conservation, gardening, running events and lots more to get you out and about in the great outdoors, enjoying our wonderful Town Park and a healthier lifestyle.

To join us, just use the contact form on our web site or fill in a form from the Visitor Centre and leave it with the staff on duty and someone will contact you directly.



www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

telford **digital bureau repro**

SHORT RUN PRINT &
DESIGN SPECIALISTS

graphic design & artwork

full colour digital printing

black & white digital printing

business forms

plan copying

CAD plotting

scanning & archiving

wide format colour scanning

wide format inkjet printing

exhibition displays

finishing services

cd duplicating

plastic id cards

Hadley Park
Telford
Shropshire
TF1 6QJ

T. 01952 670211
F. 01952 670553

Web site
www.telfordrepro.co.uk

Open 8.30am - 5.15pm
Monday - Friday

Please call for a quote